

LINUX AND MAC: QT CREATOR

Same IDE, a compiler that's already on your system

RECOMMENDED

Qt Creator on Linux and Mac

Same reasoning as Windows: it's free, cross-platform, and reads the same `CMakeLists.txt` every lecture in this course ships with. Install it via the Qt Online Installer, selecting just the Qt Creator component.

Qt Creator will pick your system compiler

Unlike Windows, Linux and Mac almost always already have a C++ compiler installed system-wide:

- Linux - usually GCC, already on the system or one `apt / dnf / pacman` install away.
- Mac - Apple Clang, installed as part of the Xcode Command Line Tools (`xcode-select --install`).

Qt Creator detects it automatically and creates a Kit for you - in most cases, you won't need to configure a Kit by hand at all.

THE CATCH

That default compiler might be old

Your distro's or macOS's system compiler is whatever version shipped when your OS was released or last updated - not necessarily the latest GCC or Clang. This course is written against **C++23**, which needs a fairly recent compiler.

A system GCC/Clang that's a few years old may not build every example in this course - that's not a mistake on your part, it's just what "the default compiler" means.

CHECKING YOUR VERSION

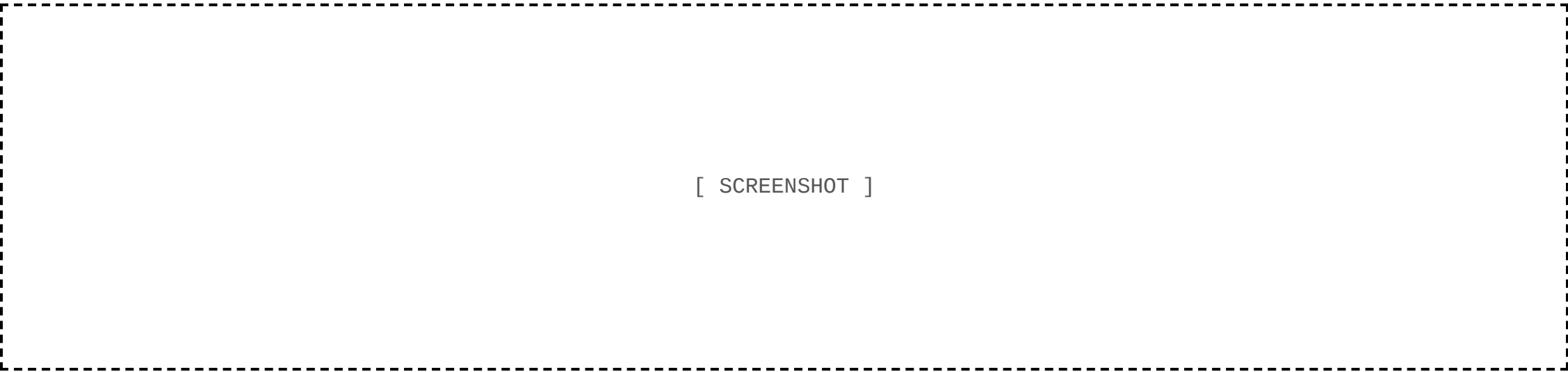
Check before you assume

```
g++ --version  
clang++ --version
```

Compare what you get against
[cppreference's compiler support table](#)
(lecture 2.5 covers this in depth).

OPENING THIS LECTURE

Building this lecture's program



[SCREENSHOT]

File -> Open File or Project, select this folder's **CMakeLists.txt**, confirm the detected Kit, then **Configure Project**. Build and run **rooster** the same way you would any Qt Creator project.

IF IT'S TOO OLD

If your compiler turns out to be too old

You don't need to upgrade your whole system compiler just for this course. Lecture 2.6 covers **Docker** - a way to get a modern GCC or Clang without touching anything already installed.